

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 6 2
♥ J 10 9 5
♦ 8 2
♣ 9 8 3 2

♠ A K Q J

♥ Q 7 2

♦ 10 9 6

♣ J 7 4



♠ 9 5

♥ 8 4

♦ A K Q J 5 4

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 7 4 3

♥ A K 6 3

♦ 7 3

♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
		1♦	Dbl
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

If you could ruff that ♦ then one of your ♦ losers would be eliminated - if West didn't over-ruff. But you know that West is going to over-ruff. So don't ruff it, discard dummy's ♣6 instead. Later you can ruff your ♣ loser in dummy.

If you had ruffed, West would have over-ruffed. And you would still have a ♣ loser. You don't have to worry about a fourth ♦ lead because you can ruff in your hand higher than any card West might ruff with.

When responding to a takeout double use these guidelines: 0-8 points: bid a suit cheaply 9-11 points: bid a suit with a jump 12 or more points: cue-bid the opponent's suit

With 13 points you cue-bid 2♦. Partner says 2♥.

You are forced to game, now you must find a suit. Partner suggested ♥s, you suggest ♠s. Partner agrees ♠s and bids the game.

North plays 4♠. East leads ♦A, ♦K, ♦Q. West plays ♦8 then ♦2.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 2
♥ J 10 3
♦ 8 5 4
♣ A K 8 5

♠ Q J 9 8

♥ A 5

♦ Q 10 6 2

♣ Q 4 3



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ Q 8 6 4

♦ A K 7

♣ J 2

♠ 10 4

♥ K 9 7 2

♦ J 9 3

♣ 10 9 7 6

West	North	East	South
	Pass	1♦	Pass
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

You have 13 points so you will definitely open the bidding. You don't open with a 4-card Major and you don't open with a 2-card ♣ suit. So this is the one distribution where you open a 3-card ♦ suit. Partner responds 2♣ and

Be very careful! You are tempted to now bid 2♥ or 2♠. Don't give in to the temptation. That would be a **REVERSE** - bidding a second, higher-ranking suit at the 2-level. You should have at least 16 points to reverse. Besides, if you trust partner you don't need to bid either of those suits anyway. If he had a 4-card Major he probably would have shown it on his first bid. No, your next bid is clearly 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you pass.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥2, North wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. South takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥2, North wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. South takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

You are glad the defense started with ♥s, that was a suit you would have had to play yourself. You need one more winner and your first thought may be that the ♠s are going to have to split 3-3. However, that happens only about 40% of the time so you keep looking. There is one more card that might be valuable, the ♣J. If North holds the ♣Q then you can make a trick out of the ♣J.

You are already in dummy with the ♥J so you lead a small ♣. If North plays low you will play the ♣J which will hold the trick and become your 9th winner. If North plays his ♣Q you will have the ♣J for your 9th winner later.

And if North doesn't have the ♣Q at all? then you **STILL** have the possibility of a 3-3 ♠ split.

As you see, this time the ♠s didn't split so you had to make the ♣J to succeed.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -
♥ A K Q 10 3
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ 10 6 3 2

♠ Q J 10 8 2
♥ 9 6 5
♦ Q 10
♣ Q 7 4



♠ K 7
♥ J 7 4
♦ A 7 5 3
♣ J 9 8 5

♠ A 9 6 5 4 3
♥ 8 2
♦ K J 8
♣ A K

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
2 ♥	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			